

FROM PDF TO PAPERBACK

HOW TO TURN YOUR 40 PAGE eBook
INTO A REAL BOOK
WITH AMAZON KDP
(Even if You're Broke)

amazon kdp



TERRANCE GEE

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📖 From PDF to Paperback: How to
Turn Your 40-Page eBook Into a
Real Book With Amazon KDP (Even
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1

✧ Chapter 1: Why Print? (Faith + Legacy + That “Author Flex”)

Listen—having an eBook is dope. But holding your words in your hands? Next-level. Imagine pulling up to an event and someone asks, “*What do you do?*” You don’t just say, “*I wrote a PDF.*” Nah, you pull a **real book** out of your bag and say, “*I’m a published author.*” That’s author flex.

Why Printing Matters

1. **Respect Level 100:** People respect physical books more than links.
2. **Legacy:** Digital files get lost. Paper lasts.
3. **Access:** Not everyone has a Kindle or likes screens.
4. **Opportunities:** You can sell books at events, churches, schools.

Faith Principle

📖 *Habakkuk 2:2* — “Write the vision, and make it plain on tablets, so he may run who reads it.”

Today those tablets include **paper**. Printing your words isn't just a flex—it's obedience to the vision God gave you.

Celebrity Energy

- **Barack Obama:** His book *Dreams from My Father* wasn't just read—it was held, gifted, studied.
- **Michelle Obama:** *Becoming* became a movement partly because people bought it in print.
- **Paul the Apostle:** His letters were literally printed, copied, and spread across nations.

Humor Break

Imagine explaining your PDF to your grandma:

- You: “Grandma, I wrote a book—it's a PDF.”
- Grandma: “Baby, print it so I can show it to Sister Johnson at church.”

Case closed. Print wins.

2

✧ Chapter 2: Amazon KDP 101: Self-Publishing Without the Gatekeepers

Back in the day, if you wanted to publish a book, you had to beg a publishing company, send letters, and pray they picked you. If they said no? Game over.

But now? **Amazon KDP (Kindle Direct Publishing)** flipped the script. No gatekeepers. No begging. Just upload and publish.

What is Amazon KDP?

- A free self-publishing platform owned by Amazon.
- Lets you publish **eBooks AND print books** (paperback & hardcover).
- Your book shows up on Amazon's global store.

Why KDP Rocks for Beginners

1. **Free to Use.** No upfront cost.
2. **Print-on-Demand.** They only print when someone orders (no stacks of books in your garage).
3. **Global Reach.** Your book is available worldwide.
4. **Royalties.** You earn 40–60% depending on pricing.

The Dashboard Flow

When you sign into KDP, you'll see:

1. **Bookshelf:** Where all your projects live.
2. **Create Button:** Start a new paperback/eBook.
3. **Step-by-Step Setup:** Title → Author → Upload File → Cover → Pricing → Publish.

It's like filling out an online form—except at the end, you're an official published author.

Faith Principle

📖 *Luke 4:18 — “The Spirit of the Lord is on me, because he has anointed me to proclaim good news...”*

KDP is your megaphone. The Spirit already gave you the words—Amazon just gives you the platform to get them out.

Humor Break

Traditional publishers: “We’ll get back to you in 6–12 months.”

Amazon KDP: “Upload today, live tomorrow.”

That’s like the difference between waiting on dial-up internet vs. WiFi.

3

✧ Chapter 3: Formatting Your Manuscript — From Word Doc to Book-Looking Doc

Alright, so you've got your 40-page eBook typed up in Word or Google Docs. That's great—but here's the thing: raw Word docs don't look like real books. You need to **format** it so it reads like something you'd pull off a Barnes & Noble shelf.

Step 1: Pick a Trim Size

Amazon KDP gives you choices like 5"x8", 6"x9", etc.

- **5"x8"** → pocket-sized, easy to carry.
- **6"x9"** → the standard paperback size (most common).

Pro tip: Pick **6x9** for your first book. It feels "real" and is the easiest to format.

Step 2: Margins and Spacing

- Use **1-inch margins** all around.
- Set **line spacing** to 1.15 or 1.5.
- Justify your text so the edges are neat (instead of ragged).

Step 3: Fonts That Don't Scream "High School Essay"

- Times New Roman works, but it feels dated.
- Better options: **Garamond, Georgia, or Palatino.**

- Font size: **11–12 pt.**

Step 4: Chapters

- Each chapter should start on a new page.
- Use "Insert → Page Break," not just a bunch of spaces.
- Add **chapter titles** in bold, bigger font.

Step 5: Page Numbers & Front Matter

- Add page numbers at the bottom (centered).
- Front matter includes:
 - Title page (book name + author)
 - Copyright page (simple: “All rights reserved.”)
 - Dedication (if you want: “To everyone who thought I couldn’t do it—God proved you wrong.”)

Free Tools to Help

1. **Word Templates from KDP:** Amazon literally gives you free templates by size.
2. **Canva Book Templates:** Export as PDF print.
3. **Reedsy Book Editor (Free Online):** Upload your doc, formats it for you.

Faith Principle

 1 Corinthians 14:40 — “Let all things be done decently and in order.”

Formatting is order. Don’t skip it. It’s not just about looking professional—it’s about respecting the message God gave you.

Humor Break

If you don't format, your book will look like a middle-school essay stapled together. And ain't nobody paying \$12.99 for "Double-Spaced Times New Roman Energy."

Exercise

Take your current eBook doc. Set the trim size to 6x9 in Word, adjust margins, and insert page breaks for each chapter. Congrats—you just leveled up from "manuscript" to "book."

4

✧ Chapter 4: Cover Design That Pops (Even If You Only Have Canva)

People **do** judge books by their covers. That's not just a saying—it's neuroscience. If your cover looks boring, your book won't even get clicked.

But here's the good news: you don't need Photoshop or \$500 designers. You can make a viral-worthy cover for **free**.

Step 1: Understand the KDP Cover

Your cover isn't just the front. You need:

- **Front cover** (the part people see first).
- **Spine** (the skinny edge with your title + name).
- **Back cover** (your author bio + blurb).

KDP has a **free cover calculator/template** where you enter your trim size and page count, and it gives you exact dimensions.

Step 2: Design Tools

1. **Canva (Free):** The GOAT for beginners.
 - Search “book cover.”
 - Pick a template.
 - Customize with your title, name, and image.
1. **BookBrush (Free trial):** Great for 3D mockups (like those cool floating book pics you see on IG).
2. **GIMP (Free Photoshop alternative):** If you want extra power.

Step 3: Make It Pop

- **Big Fonts.** The title should be readable in a thumbnail.
- **Bold Colors.** Black & gold = luxury. Red = urgent. Blue = trust.
- **Striking Images.** Free stock sites: Unsplash, Pexels, Pixabay.

Step 4: The Back Cover

This is where you sell the reader.

- Short description (make it dramatic, make it hopeful).
- Author bio (be funny + real). Example: *“Terrance Gee went from struggle to strength, and now he’s on a mission to show young adults how to turn their stories into books, businesses, and legacies.”*

Celebrity Inspiration

- **Michelle Obama’s *Becoming***: Minimalist, classy, bold.
- **Rick Ross’s *Hurricanes***: Strong photo, name front-and-center.
- **Bible Covers**: Iconic because of simplicity + power.

Faith Principle

📖 *Matthew 5:16* — “Let your light shine before others.”

Your cover is literally your light shining on a crowded Amazon shelf. Don’t hide it—make it glow.

Humor Break

If your cover looks like it was made in Microsoft Paint, people will treat it like a flyer for lost kittens. Spend the extra 20 minutes in Canva—it's free.

Exercise

Go to Canva, pick a “book cover” template, and create a mock-up with your book's title. Export it as PNG. Now show it to 3 friends. If they don't say “That looks legit,” back to the drawing board.

5

✧ Chapter 5: ISBNs, Barcodes, and Other Scary Words Explained Simply

Okay, let's deal with the elephant in the room: **ISBNs and barcodes.**

Most new authors hear those words and freeze like they just got called on in math class. But relax—it's simpler than it sounds.

What Is an ISBN?

ISBN = **I**nternational **S**tandard **B**ook **N**umber.

- It's basically your book's fingerprint.
- Every published book has one.
- It makes your book official and trackable in bookstores, libraries, and Amazon.

Do You Need an ISBN?

- **Yes** for print books.
- **No** for eBooks (Amazon gives eBooks an ASIN instead).

The Barcode

The barcode is tied to your ISBN. It's what gets scanned at checkout in a bookstore. Amazon automatically generates this for you if you use their free ISBN.

Free ISBN vs. Buying One

1. **Amazon KDP Free ISBN**

- Pro: Free.
- Pro: Auto-assigned to your book.
- Con: Amazon listed as the “publisher.”

1. **Buying Your Own ISBN** (via Bowker in the U.S.)

- Pro: You're listed as the official publisher (flex).
- Con: Costs about \$125 for one, \$295 for ten.

Recommendation

If you're broke and just starting: **use the free KDP ISBN**. Your audience won't care—it'll still look legit. Later, when you build your brand, buy your own ISBN block.

Faith Principle

📖 *Proverbs 4:7* — “*Wisdom is the principal thing; therefore get wisdom.*”

Don't let ISBNs intimidate you. Wisdom makes the complicated simple.

Humor Break

Think of ISBNs like Social Security Numbers. You don't need to know how they're made—you just need to have one. Nobody's walking around saying: “Oh man, my SSN isn't fancy enough.” Same with ISBNs—use the free one.

Exercise

Log into your KDP account. Start a paperback project. When you reach the ISBN section, select **Free KDP ISBN**. Boom—you've just demystified the scariest part of publishing.

6

✧ Chapter 6: Uploading Like a Pro — Step-by-Step KDP Dashboard Walkthrough

Now that you've got your manuscript formatted, your cover looking fire, and your ISBN handled, it's time for the big moment: **uploading to KDP.**

Don't worry—it's basically filling out a form. Let's walk through it.

Step 1: Log Into KDP

- Go to kdp.amazon.com.
- Hit "Create" → "Paperback."

Step 2: Paperback Details

- **Book Title:** Keep it clear + catchy. (Ex: *From PDF to Paperback*).
- **Subtitle:** Add flavor. (Ex: *A Faith-Fueled Guide to Publishing Your First Book on Amazon*).
- **Author Name:** That's you, fam. (Pro tip: always use the same name for consistency).
- **Description:** This is your back-cover blurb. Make it dramatic + hopeful.
- **Keywords:** Add 7 keywords people might search (faith, financial literacy, young adults, inspiration).
- **Categories:** Choose 2. Example: "Self-help / Christian Living."

Step 3: ISBN + Print Options

- Use your free ISBN (unless you bought one).
- Choose your trim size (6x9 recommended).
- Choose paper color (white looks professional; cream feels more "novel-style").
- Choose matte or glossy cover (matte = classy, glossy = flashy).

Step 4: Upload Files

- **Manuscript (PDF):** Upload your formatted file.
- **Cover (PDF):** Upload your Canva design.

KDP will check if everything fits. If it doesn't, they'll give you error messages (usually about margins or spine). Don't freak out—just adjust and re-upload.

Step 5: Preview Your Book

KDP has a **3D Previewer**. You'll see your book in full—front, back, and inside pages. Scroll through carefully. If it looks off, fix it before publishing.

Step 6: Pricing

- Set your price (we'll dive deep in Chapter 7).
- KDP will show you your royalty breakdown.

Step 7: Publish!

Click “Publish.” Within 24–72 hours, Amazon reviews it. Then boom—it’s live. Your name, your book, worldwide.

Faith Principle

📖 *Matthew 25:23 — “Well done, good and faithful servant.”*

This is that “publish” moment. You’ve been faithful through the writing and formatting—now it’s time to multiply it.

Humor Break

The first time you see your book live on Amazon? Instant “I made it” energy. You’ll refresh the page 27 times just to stare at your name under that cover. And yes—you’ll screenshot it and send it to everybody. That’s mandatory.

Exercise

Log into KDP and do a test upload (you don’t have to publish yet). Go through the steps until you hit preview. Congrats—you’re officially a self-publisher in training.

7

✧ Chapter 7: Pricing That Sells (Without Undervaluing Your Worth)

So you've uploaded your book. Now comes the money talk: **pricing.**

This is where a lot of new authors mess up. Some price their books so low it looks cheap. Others price it too high and wonder why nobody buys. Let's fix that.

Understanding KDP Pricing

Amazon gives you:

- **Printing Cost** (based on page count, paper, and trim size).
- **Your List Price** (what readers pay).
- **Royalty Rate** (what you keep—usually 60%).

Example:

- Your 40-page paperback costs \$2.50 to print.

- You price it at \$9.99.
- Amazon takes \$2.50 for printing, \$1.50 for their cut.
- You keep \$5.99 per sale.

The Sweet Spot

For a 40–60 page paperback, the best price is usually **\$7.99 to \$11.99**.

Why?

- Under \$5 = feels cheap, like a pamphlet.
- Over \$15 = feels overpriced, especially for young adults.
- \$9.99 = perfect “psychological pricing.” People see it as affordable but valuable.

Add Value, Not Just Pages

Don’t stress if your book is “only” 40 pages. Quality beats quantity. Remember: *The Four Agreements* (a bestseller) is only about 140 pages and still sells millions. Your message is the value.

Humor Break

Don't price your book like it's a pack of ramen noodles. And don't price it like it's Beyoncé's tour tickets either. Find the middle ground where people can say: *"I'll buy this and still have money for Chick-fil-A."*

Faith Principle

📖 1 Timothy 5:18 — *"The worker deserves his wages."*

Translation: Don't be ashamed to charge. Your story has worth. Your wisdom has worth. God wants you to prosper, not just post PDFs for free.

Pro Hack

Offer discounts during launch week:

- Price at \$6.99 for launch (to get sales + reviews).
- Raise to \$9.99 later for long-term profit.

Exercise

Go to your KDP dashboard, test pricing at \$9.99, and look at the royalty breakdown. Write down how many books you'd need to sell to make your first \$100. Spoiler: it's usually under 20.

8

✧ Chapter 8: Proof Copies — Holding Your Dream in Your Hands

This is the part that'll make you cry (happy tears). When you order a **proof copy**, you get to physically hold your book before it goes live.

What's a Proof Copy?

- A test version of your book Amazon prints just for you.
- It's marked "Not for Resale" on the back (so you can't sell it).
- Lets you check formatting, cover, and paper quality before launch.

Why Proofs Matter

1. **Spot Errors:** Typos, weird spacing, or cover misalignments show up more in print than on screen.
2. **Feel the Book:** Is it too thin? Too big? The proof tells you.
3. **Emotional Boost:** Seeing your book in your hands is motivation on 1000.

How to Order a Proof

1. After uploading in KDP, click **Request Proof Copy**.
2. Amazon prints and mails it (usually takes 5–10 days).
3. Hold it, flip through, and check everything.

What to Check in Your Proof

- Is the cover aligned? (No text cut off?)
- Are margins good? (Words not too close to the edge?)
- Is the font size comfortable?
- Are there typos you missed on screen?

Faith Principle

📖 *Hebrews 11:1* — “Now faith is confidence in what we hope for and assurance about what we do not see.”

When you hold that proof copy, it's faith made visible. What was once only in your head is now in your hands.

Humor Break

The first time you get your proof copy, you'll take 37 selfies with it, carry it around like a newborn, and probably sleep with it on the nightstand. Don't worry—that's normal.

Pro Hack

Order **two proofs**. Keep one clean, mark one up with corrections. That way you can edit without ruining your “trophy copy.”

Exercise

After uploading your manuscript and cover, order a proof. Write down how it feels to hold it. That's your “faith-to-fruition” moment—never forget it.

✧ Chapter 9: Distribution — From Your Laptop to the World

So you've written, formatted, priced, and proofed your book. Now let's talk about **distribution**. Basically: *Where does your book go once you hit publish?*

Where Amazon Puts Your Book

When you publish through KDP:

1. **Amazon.com** (U.S. store).
2. **International Stores** (UK, Canada, Australia, etc.).
3. **Expanded Distribution** (optional: puts your book in catalogs for bookstores & libraries).

eBook vs. Paperback Distribution

- **eBook:** Instant worldwide via Kindle Store.
- **Paperback:** Printed on demand → available worldwide through Amazon.
- **Expanded Distribution:** Lets Barnes & Noble, Walmart, and libraries *order* your book (though they may not stock it unless demand is there).

Pros of Amazon Distribution

- Global reach — your book can be ordered in London, Lagos, or Los Angeles.
- No upfront costs — books print only when ordered.
- Automatic fulfillment — Amazon handles shipping, printing, and customer service.

Cons of Amazon Distribution

- You don't control buyer data (you don't know *who* bought your book unless they tell you).
- Expanded distribution royalties are lower.
- Physical bookstores don't *love* stocking Amazon-published books.

Real Talk

Don't stress over getting into Barnes & Noble right now. Focus on Amazon first — it's where 70%+ of book sales happen.

Faith Principle

📖 *Mark 16:15 — “Go into all the world and preach the gospel to all creation.”*

Distribution is your book's way of going into the world. Your message is now global.

Humor Break

You'll feel like DJ Khaled: *“Another one...another country...another order.”* Seeing someone in Australia buy your book hits different. You'll be like: *“Mate, I'm international now!”*

Exercise

In your KDP dashboard, select **Expanded Distribution**. Then make a list of 5 countries where you dream of your book being read. Pray over it. Speak it into existence.

10

✧ Chapter 10: Marketing Like Drake (Virality) + T.D. Jakes (Authority)

Listen—writing the book is half the battle. The other half?

Getting people to actually buy it.

That's where marketing comes in.

Two Types of Marketing Energy

1. **Drake Energy (Virality):** Get people hyped, talking, and sharing.
2. **T.D. Jakes Energy (Authority):** Position yourself as someone people listen to, respect, and trust.

You need both.

Step 1: Social Media Hype (Drake Energy 🦁)

- Post your book cover mockup BEFORE it drops.
- Share behind-the-scenes videos (“I just got my proof copy!”).
- Create short reels/TikToks with trending sounds.
- Meme yourself! Example: a photo of you holding the proof with the caption: *“Me: I can’t write a book. Also me: publishes a whole book.”*

Step 2: Faith-Based Authority (T.D. Jakes Energy)

- Share your WHY. People buy stories, not just books.
- Talk about how God guided your writing.
- Use scripture with your posts — let people see this is bigger than just business.
- Do short devotionals tied to your book themes.

Step 3: Ask for Reviews

Amazon reviews = credibility.

- Text 10 friends directly.
- Post “Who wants a free PDF copy in exchange for an honest

Amazon review?"

- Reviews boost your ranking = more strangers find your book.

Step 4: Go Local First

- Speak at youth groups, churches, or community events.
- Donate copies to libraries or schools.
- Sell signed copies at small pop-ups.

Step 5: Think Long-Term

Books don't just sell in launch week. They sell for years if you keep promoting.

- Use quotes from your book as weekly IG/TikTok posts.
- Turn chapters into podcast episodes.
- Bundle your book into workshops, coaching, or merch.

Faith Principle

 *Habakkuk 2:2 — "Write the vision, and make it plain... that he may run that readeth it."*

Your book is the vision. Marketing makes it plain. Don't hide your light—put it on Instagram, TikTok, YouTube, everywhere.

Humor Break

Marketing your book is like sliding into DMs: you can't just send one message and give up. You gotta follow up, stay consistent, and keep the energy high.

Exercise

Make a 7-day promo plan:

- Day 1: Announce your book.
- Day 2: Share a scripture + a quote from your book.
- Day 3: Show your proof copy.
- Day 4: Share a funny meme.
- Day 5: Testimonial (friend/family review).
- Day 6: Live video Q&A.
- Day 7: "Last chance to grab at launch price!"

11

✧ Chapter 11: Building Your Author Brand — From Nobody to Notable

Okay, real talk: publishing a book is **bigger than just writing words**. You're building a *brand*. That means when people see your name, they instantly think: "*That's the one who wrote that dope book.*"

What Is an Author Brand?

- **Your Style:** The way you write, talk, and show up online.
- **Your Message:** What you stand for (faith, empowerment, resilience).
- **Your Vibe:** The energy you give off—funny, deep, motivational, real.

Why Brand Matters

People don't just buy books; they buy **people**.

- They buy YOU because they connect with your story.
- They buy YOU because you're consistent.
- They buy YOU because they feel you're authentic.

How to Build Your Author Brand

1. **Choose Your Name Wisely**

- Always use the same name across all platforms (ex: "Terrence Gee" everywhere).
- No random nicknames on IG and full government name on Amazon. Be consistent.

1. **Be Present Online**

- Share snippets of your writing journey.
- Share faith-based wisdom tied to your book's message.
- Post wins, struggles, and lessons learned.

1. **Use Visual Branding**

- Get a consistent look for your posts.
- Canva = your best friend (make templates).
- Stick to 2–3 colors and fonts that match your vibe.

1. Network Like Crazy

- Collaborate with other writers, speakers, and faith leaders.
- Comment on their posts. Share their stuff. Build relationships.

Faith Principle

Matthew 5:14 — “*You are the light of the world. A town built on a hill cannot be hidden.*”

Your book is your lamp. Your author brand is how you shine it. Don't dim it—shine consistently.

Humor Break

Building an author brand is like dating. If you show up one week, disappear for three months, then pop back up like “Hey, stranger,” people won't take you seriously. Be consistent.

Exercise

Write down three words you want people to think of when they hear your name (ex: inspiring, faith-driven, funny). Build all your posts and promotions around those words.

12

✧ Chapter 12: Leaving a Legacy — Why Your Book Is Bigger Than You

This chapter is where it all comes together. Writing a book isn't just about *today's sales*. It's about **legacy**.

Why Legacy Matters

1. **Books Outlive You**

- Long after you're gone, your book will still be around.
- Your kids, grandkids, even strangers decades from now can read your words.

1. **Books Multiply Impact**

- You can only preach to so many people in person.
- A book preaches for you, 24/7, in every corner of the world.

1. **Books Inspire Generations**

- Imagine a 19-year-old in 2045 finding your book on a dusty shelf and saying: “*This changed my life.*”

The Legacy Formula

Book = Seed.

You plant it now, God waters it, and future generations reap the harvest.

Viral Legacy Examples

- *The Bible* — written thousands of years ago, still the most impactful book ever.
- Tupac’s music — decades later, people still quote him.
- Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. — books and speeches still inspire generations.

Humor Break

Imagine your grandkids flexing in school: “*Yeah, my grandma wrote that bestseller back in the day. She was like Beyoncé with a Bible verse.*” Legacy is bragging rights for your future family.

Faith Principle

📖 *John 15:16 — “You did not choose me, but I chose you and appointed you so that you might go and bear fruit — fruit that will last.”*

Your book is fruit that lasts. It's not just pages—it's ministry.

Exercise

Write a letter to your future self, 20 years from now. Imagine how your book has impacted lives. Seal it, save it, and let that vision fuel your next steps.

Conclusion: You Did It!

You've officially gone from **idea** → **manuscript** → **Amazon KDP paperback** → **author brand** → **legacy**.

This isn't just about publishing a book—it's about changing lives, starting with your own.

Remember:

- Your words matter.
- Your story has value.
- Your faith will carry you.

Now go hit that “Publish” button and walk boldly into your destiny.